of their respective government's territorial claims resolved the dispute.[45] Even as these discussions were in progress, both sides set about consolidating their presence and position along the border. China continued to build roads, establish new posts, carry out forward patrols, and beef up its military deployment. By September–October 1961, it had established 61 new posts, constructed a network of roads, and deployed an estimated 45 battalions all along the border. The number of troops deployed increased further to 61 battalions (equivalent to seven Indian infantry divisions) by May 1962. By the time China initiated war in October 1962, it had deployed artillery units and increased the total number of troops along the border to the equivalent of eight divisions.[46]

Yet Nehru persisted with his three-pronged policy of preserving India's security and territorial integrity, maintaining friendly relations with China, and helping the people of Tibet, although he did acknowledge that "certain contradictions" and "difficult choices" were involved in pursuing these imperatives.[47] According to Sarvepalli Gopal, Nehru's policy had to harmonise "four seemingly conflicting objectives": help Tibet while maintaining China's friendship and ensure national security without abandoning nonalignment.[48] With respect to the Tibetan revolt, although Indians were moved by "the feeling of kinship" for Tibetans and their veneration for the Dalai Lama to voice support for the Tibetan cause, the Indian government limited itself to granting asylum to the Tibetan leader and tens of thousands of his followers, refrained from recognising the government-in-exile, and requested it to "function with restraint and responsibility."[49] Simultaneously, Nehru continued to speak of friendship and cooperation and offered to settle the boundary issue through bilateral negotiations or even international mediation and arbitration so long as China accepted the general alignment of the border, the principles